

Joseph Farodoye: That's amazing. Did you ever get to meet him?

Chidi Ajufo: Yeah, I did meet him. It was a brief encounter, just a quick "Hey, what's up?" but it was still pretty cool.

Joseph Farodoye: And from stunt doubling, you moved on to more substantial roles. What was your first big speaking part?

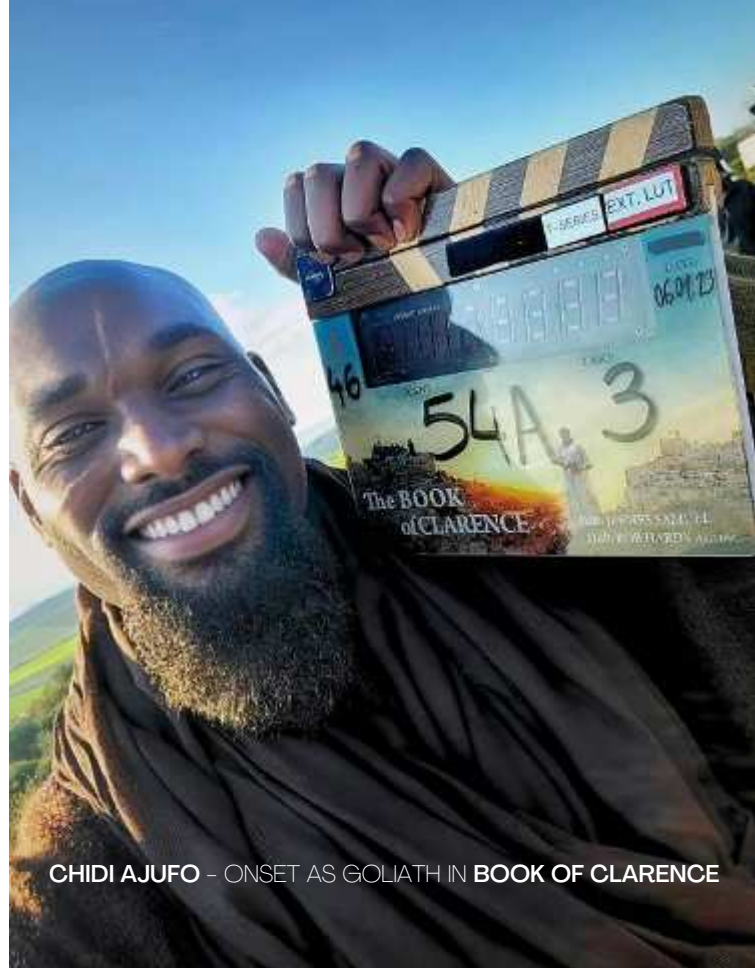
Chidi Ajufo: My first major speaking role was on the TV series 'Training Day' in 2017. It was significant because it was my first mainstream production. I guest-starred in one episode alongside Bill Paxton, a legendary actor who unfortunately passed away shortly after due to heart surgery complications. Working with him was incredible; it felt like I had arrived on the scene.

Joseph Farodoye: How did that experience feel compared to your earlier roles?

Chidi Ajufo: It was different. Before that, I had done some independent projects and YouTube stuff that were more underground. 'Training Day' was my first taste of the mainstream, and it felt like a real milestone.

Joseph Farodoye: Who was the first big star to embrace you or make you feel welcomed in the industry?

Chidi Ajufo: That would be Kate Beckinsale. In 2018, I worked with her on the TV series 'The Widow' in South Africa. We had a fight scene where she had to beat me up, and she was constantly checking if I was okay. I told



her I'd been a fan since 'Pearl Harbor', which seemed to put her at ease. She was incredibly warm and made me feel comfortable on set.

Joseph Farodoye: It sounds like she had a big impact on you. Did you find that being a "big black guy" influenced how people treated you on set?

Chidi Ajufo: Sometimes, yes. It can be intimidating for some people. But with Kate, it wasn't an issue. I think she appreciated my admiration for her work, and that made it easier for us to connect.

Joseph Farodoye: You've mentioned before that you're often cast as the "big bad guy." Do you feel typecast in these roles?

Chidi Ajufo: Definitely. I'm trying to move away from that. I don't want to be limited to one role.

I've been fortunate to land roles that have allowed me to show different sides, like in the film 'On the Other Foot'. It was a comedy, and I got to be more of myself, which was refreshing.

Joseph Farodoye: Speaking of diverse roles, you're in 'Gladiator 2', which is huge. But I'm particularly intrigued by 'The Book of Clarence'. Can you tell us more about that?

Chidi Ajufo: 'The Book of Clarence' is an original story by Jeymes Samuel, who is an incredibly talented director, writer, musician, and artist. The film is set in Biblical times but isn't a Bible story. It follows a man named Clarence who, after seeing Jesus, decides he wants to emulate him but for selfish reasons – like money and fame. My character, Goliath, is one of the names Samuel uses creatively. It's a dramatic comedy with a lot of depth and inspiration.

Joseph Farodoye: That sounds fantastic. How was it working with Jeymes and the cast?

Chidi Ajufo: It was an incredible experience. Jeymes made it feel like we were working with friends. The cast was diverse and brilliant – Michael Ward, Nicholas Pinnock, LaKeith Stanfield, Teyana Taylor.

We bonded over our shared heritage and backgrounds, and it was a very musical set. There was always a vibe, always rhythm, and that energy comes through in the movie.

Joseph Farodoye: Your journey is inspiring, from the basketball courts of Lagos to the bright lights of Hollywood. What do you attribute your success to?

Chidi Ajufo: Hard work, faith, and a little bit of luck. I believe in manifestation, in being where you want to be mentally and spiritually before you get there physically. I manifest daily, in my prayers and routines, and I think that has played a big role in my journey.

Joseph Farodoye: Thank you, Chidi, for sharing your story. It's been a pleasure.

Chidi Ajufo: Thank you! It's been great chatting with you.



CHARLIE HUNNAM AND CHIDI AJUFO
ONSET BTS THE GENTLEMEN





TIFFANEE MARIE LIM

VICE PRESIDENT LIMKOK WING UNIVERSITY

By Joseph Farodoye, Editor in Chief

NAVIGATING GLOBAL CHALLENGES AND OPPORTUNITIES IN THE DIGITAL AGE

In the heart of a rapidly changing world, where technology and tradition collide, leadership isn't just about making decisions—it's about guiding a vision that resonates across borders, cultures, and markets.

Recently, I had the privilege of speaking with Tiffanee Marie Lim, Vice President of Limkokwing University, who embodies this ethos, steering a global organization with 2,000 employees spread across 15 locations in 13 countries.

Our conversation delved deep into the essence of leadership, the transformative power of technology, and the future of education. Here are some of the most insightful moments from our exchange.

Joseph Farodoye: Managing a global organization of this scale requires more than just operational acumen. How do you maintain the pulse of your team spread across so many countries?

Tiffanee Marie Lim: It's a balancing act, truly. The key is vigilance and energy management. Every day, I strive to ensure fairness and patience permeate our operations, from the C-suite to the front lines. It's about being present, even when you're not physically there. I constantly remind myself that leadership isn't about dictating from the top—it's about fostering an environment where every individual feels seen, heard, and valued. This, I believe, cultivates a culture of respect and loyalty, essential ingredients for navigating the complex global landscape.





BEING PRESENT AND STRIVING FOR PATIENCE AND FAIRNESS

JF: Your emphasis on fairness and patience is refreshing. How do you maintain this mindset, especially in times of challenge?

Tiffanee: It's all about perspective. Challenges, in my view, are just opportunities in disguise. Maintaining a positive mindset, being kind to oneself, and extending that kindness to others is crucial. This approach doesn't only help in business but also in personal growth. Over the years, I've learned that personal development and professional success are deeply intertwined. Investing in mentorship and fostering a culture of continuous learning are vital. We need to equip our teams not just with job-specific skills but with transferable skills that prepare them for whatever the future may hold.



JF: Speaking of the future, how has technology, particularly during the COVID-19 pandemic, reshaped your organization's operations?

Tiffanee: The pandemic was a turning point, accelerating our shift to remote work and digital transformation. Overnight, we had to rethink our approach to collaboration and communication. Technology became our lifeline, allowing us to connect, innovate, and sustain our operations. But beyond that, it highlighted the potential of AI and other digital tools in reshaping industries, especially education.



SHAPING A LEGACY WHERE INNOVATION MEETS COMPASSION

Tiffanee: We witnessed firsthand the profound impact AI can have, not just in content generation but in enhancing how we learn and teach. It's an exciting yet challenging time, and it's clear that those who embrace these technological advancements will be at the forefront of the industry.

JF: You mentioned education—how do you see the role of universities evolving in this tech-driven world?

Tiffanee: This is a topic close to my heart. Education must evolve beyond simply preparing students for employment. Universities should be places that foster character development, resilience, and a sense of purpose. The traditional model of learning is being challenged, and rightly so. We need to rethink how we teach and what we teach, incorporating not just technical skills but also emotional intelligence, critical thinking, and adaptability. The future belongs to those who are not just intelligent but wise—those who can navigate the complexities of a globalized, digital world with empathy and insight.

JF: There's a lot of talk about digital currencies and smart payments. How do you see this affecting education and business in the future?

Tiffanee: The shift towards digital currencies is inevitable, especially as we move towards a more contactless society. For universities, this could mean rethinking tuition payments, alumni donations, and even daily transactions on campus. It's about convenience and security, yes, but also about inclusivity.



Tiffanee: Digital currencies can bridge the gap, offering more people access to education and business opportunities. However, this also requires a robust framework to ensure these systems are secure and universally accepted.

JF: Finally, what drives you as a leader? What inspires you to continue pushing the boundaries?

Tiffanee: I'm inspired by the potential to make a difference, to leave a legacy that transcends profits and business success. It's about creating a positive impact, shaping a future where innovation and compassion go hand in hand. Witnessing the struggles and triumphs of different cultures has humbled me and given me a deeper appreciation for the diversity of the human experience. My goal is to harness the power of business, technology, and education to build bridges, uplift communities, and inspire the next generation to lead with integrity, vision, and a sense of shared humanity.



ABIMBOLA OGUNBANJO

Champion of Corporate Leadership

Tribute 1962-2024



A LEGACY OF INTEGRITY AND EXCELLENCE

It is with profound respect and heartfelt appreciation that we celebrate the life and legacy of Abimbola Ogunbanjo, former President of the Nigerian Stock Exchange (NSE) and an esteemed lawyer, who passed away leaving behind a monumental legacy. Ogunbanjo's life was one defined by a steadfast commitment to excellence, ethical leadership, and the pursuit of a vibrant and transparent capital market in Nigeria. His contributions to the NSE and the broader financial ecosystem have left an indelible mark that will be felt for generations to come.

Throughout his tenure as the President of the NSE, Ogunbanjo was a tireless advocate for robust corporate governance and market integrity. Under his leadership, the Exchange underwent significant reforms that enhanced market transparency, safeguarded investor interests, and instilled a culture of accountability among listed companies.

His dedication to creating a fair and open market environment set new benchmarks for the Nigerian capital market, elevating its standards and making it more attractive to both local and international investors.

Ogunbanjo's expertise in corporate law was instrumental in driving these transformative changes. He played a pivotal role in modernizing the regulatory framework of the Nigerian capital market, ensuring that it could compete on a global scale.

CHAMPION OF CORPORATE GOVERNANCE

His efforts not only restored investor confidence but also positioned the NSE as a leading exchange in Africa, fostering economic growth and development across the continent.

Beyond his professional achievements, Abimbola Ogunbanjo was a mentor and a beacon of inspiration for many young professionals. He was deeply committed to ethical leadership and continuous professional development, nurturing a new generation of corporate leaders in Nigeria who look up to his example of integrity and excellence. Ogunbanjo's legacy is not only in the institutions he helped shape but also in the lives of those he mentored and the ethical standards he championed.

His contributions extended beyond the boardroom and into the community. Ogunbanjo was actively involved in various philanthropic initiatives, with a particular focus on education and youth empowerment. He believed in the power of education to transform lives and worked tirelessly to provide opportunities for young people to achieve their fullest potential. His philanthropic efforts have touched countless lives and will continue to inspire future generations.

In remembering Abimbola Ogunbanjo, we are reminded of the importance of visionary leadership, innovation, and unwavering commitment to ethical standards.





CHAMPION OF CORPORATE GOVERNANCE

His legacy is characterized by a dedication to building stronger, more resilient institutions capable of withstanding the challenges of a dynamic global economy. The foundations he laid will undoubtedly continue to support the growth and development of Nigerian businesses and the broader economy.

We thank you, Abimbola Ogunbanjo, for your exceptional service, your unwavering integrity, and your profound impact on the Nigerian financial landscape. Your legacy will endure inspiring those who follow in your footsteps to strive for excellence and to lead with purpose and integrity. As we celebrate your life, we extend our deepest condolences to your family and friends, who have lost a beloved husband, father, mentor, and friend. May your soul rest in perfect peace, and may your legacy of excellence and integrity continue to shine brightly.





HERBERT WIGWE

Visionary of Nigerian Finance

Tribute 1966-2024



HERBERT WIGWE

In the ever-evolving landscape of Nigerian finance and corporate leadership, two names stand out for their remarkable contributions and transformative impact: Herbert Wigwe and Abimbola Ogunbanjo. Their leadership, innovation, and dedication have not only propelled their respective institutions to new heights but have also set new standards for excellence and integrity in the Nigerian business environment.

Herbert Wigwe: Architect of Modern Banking

Herbert Wigwe, the former Group Managing Director and CEO of Access Bank, is a visionary leader whose strategic insights and relentless pursuit of excellence have revolutionised Nigerian banking. Since assuming leadership at Access Bank, Wigwe has steered the institution through a period of unprecedented growth and expansion. Under his stewardship, Access Bank has grown from a mid-sized player into one of Africa's largest and most respected financial institutions.



ARCHITECT OF MODERN BANKING

Wigwe's approach to banking has always been customer-centric and technology-driven. He recognised early on the potential of digital banking and has been instrumental in integrating cutting-edge technologies to enhance customer experience and operational efficiency. His commitment to sustainability and corporate social responsibility has also been noteworthy, with Access Bank undertaking numerous initiatives aimed at promoting financial inclusion and supporting community development.

Wigwe's leadership extends beyond the confines of Access Bank. He is a vocal advocate for regulatory reforms and industry collaboration, believing that a robust and transparent banking sector is crucial for economic development. His contributions have earned him numerous accolades, including recognition as one of the most influential CEOs in Africa.



WOMEN IN BLOCKCHAIN



AFRICA LEADING THE WAY

YALIWE SOKO



BLOCKCHAIN FOR SOCIAL GOOD

A

Smile that lights up the room, a razor sharp mind, adventurous spirit and curious nature, introducing Yaliwe Soko, Chairwoman of United Africa Blockchain Association

(UABA), Founder of Essence Crypto Consultants, Founder of Umoja, and Ethereum Foundation Devcon Alumni. Yaliwe completely and utterly shatters the mold for developers of Blockchain everywhere. As an early adopter of Blockchain, Yaliwe has been pivotal to demonstrating the many benefits it provides to marginalised communities.

With her campaign to train 1 million people in Blockchain, Yaliwe is well underway to exceeding her target having already trained over 180,000 people in one of the most innovative technologies of our time.

Clearly passionate about education, technology's ability to greatly benefit financial inclusion and the empowerment of women, Yaliwe has been actively involved in driving Africa's adoption of Blockchain through education and training campaigns led by the United Africa Blockchain Association. UABA is a non-profit organisation formed for the promotion and adoption of Blockchain technology in Africa, creating

partnerships and networks that deliver on life-changing Blockchain projects.

Under Yaliwe's leadership UABA has already established chapters in 9 African countries including Cameroon, Ghana, Kenya, Nigeria, Togo, Uganda, South Africa, Zambia and Zimbabwe, with Botswana and Malawi to be added soon. In addition to all of this, UABA also assists in bringing venture capital to African tech start-ups via the UABA Start Up Initiative. This initiative was set up to help create life changing businesses on the Blockchain eco-system across the continent.

From Blockchain technology, web development to cryptocurrency courses, Yaliwe's ethos as leader of UABA is to 'train the trainer' and develop Blockchain educators that provide quality Blockchain awareness.

Long gone are the days of rooms sprinkled with empty soda bottles and half-eaten pizza slices laying dishevelled in boxes, with developers glued to computer screens building code purely for other coders to admire. Blockchain is blazing a trail across Africa for social good with the most influential woman in Blockchain within Africa, Yaliwe Soko, at its helm.

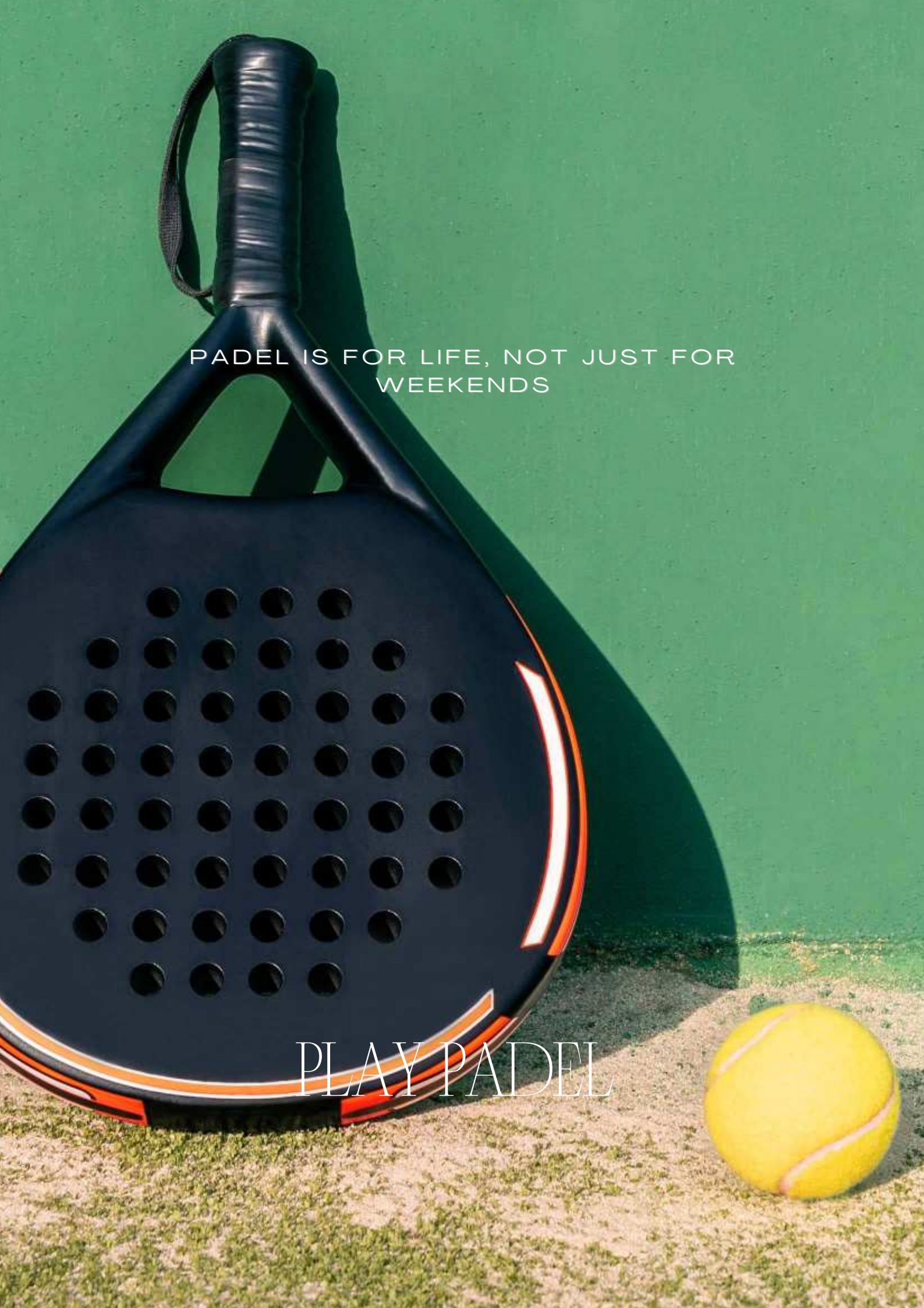
For more information email:

✉ info@bluxecentury.com

LIFESTYLE

COMFORT TO ALL



A black and orange padel racket with a perforated face is positioned diagonally across the frame. The racket's handle is wrapped in black tape. To the right of the racket, a yellow padel ball with a pink stripe lies on a patch of grass and sand. The background is a solid green wall. The text "PADEL IS FOR LIFE, NOT JUST FOR WEEKENDS" is centered in the upper half, and "PLAY PADEL" is centered in the lower half.

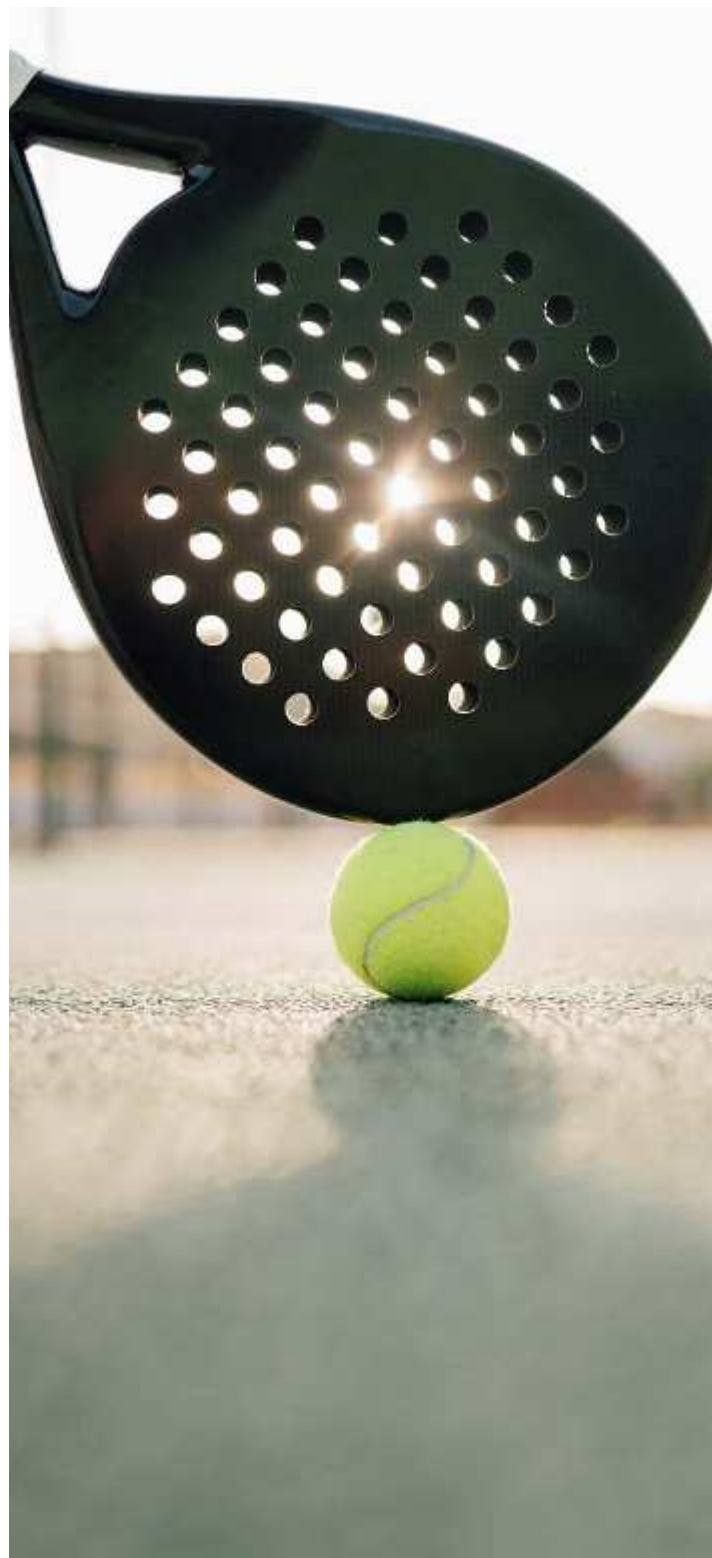
PADEL IS FOR LIFE, NOT JUST FOR
WEEKENDS

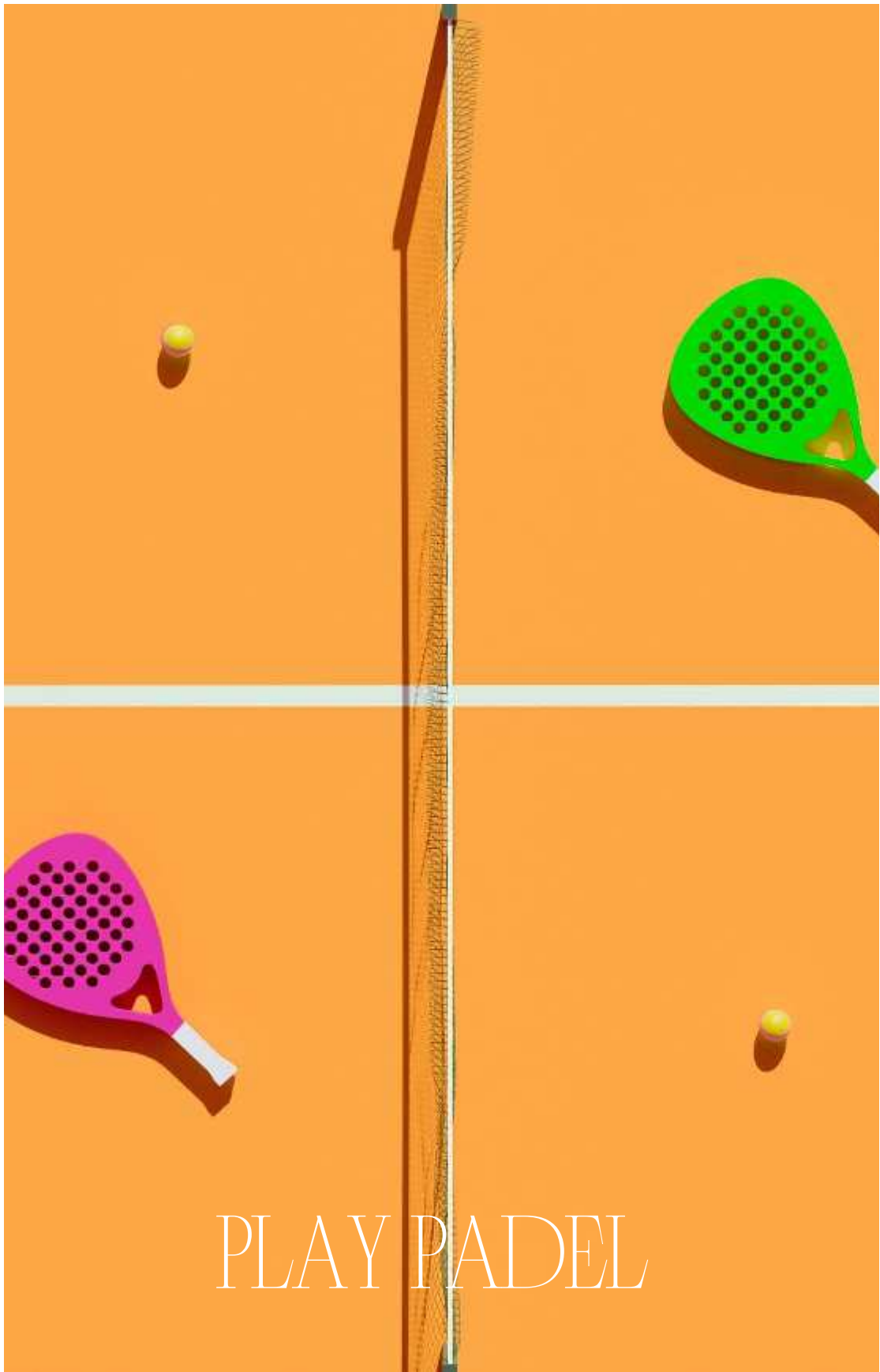
PLAY PADEL

THE GLOBAL RISE OF PADEL

Padel, a hybrid sport combining elements of tennis and squash, is experiencing a meteoric rise globally, attracting consumers, players, and major corporate investments. Originating in Mexico in the 1960s, padel has surged in popularity, especially in Europe and Latin America, and is now expanding rapidly into new markets worldwide.

Several factors contribute to padel's growing appeal. The sport's accessibility, requiring less technical skill than tennis, makes it enjoyable for a broad age range and skill levels. Its social nature—typically played in doubles—enhances its attractiveness, fostering a community spirit among players. Additionally, the relatively small court size makes it feasible for urban areas where space is limited.





PLAY PADEL

A GAME-CHANGER

Corporate giants have recognized the sport's potential. In 2023 alone, over 150 companies have invested in padel, with total investments exceeding \$500 million. Prominent examples include Adidas, which has committed \$50 million towards developing new equipment and sponsoring major tournaments, and Nike, which has allocated \$45 million for marketing campaigns and grassroots initiatives to promote the sport in emerging markets. Real estate developers and fitness chains, such as WeWork and Equinox, are also constructing padel courts to attract and retain members.

The sport's growth is particularly evident in regions like Europe and Latin America. Spain leads the charge, with over 20,000 padel courts and millions of active players. Argentina follows closely, where the sport rivals soccer in popularity. Additionally, the Middle East is seeing significant investment, with countries like the UAE and Saudi Arabia building state-of-the-art padel facilities to cater to the growing interest. In Asia, countries such as Japan and China are beginning to embrace the sport, with new clubs and courts emerging in major cities.



The global expansion of padel represents a unique convergence of sport, community, and business. As investments continue to pour in and new regions embrace the game, padel's trajectory suggests it will soon become a mainstay in the global sporting landscape.





LOVE IS
is in
THE AIR

A TRAVEL *symphony*

An aviation luminary once eloquently stated, "The sensation of flight embodies freedom, exhilaration, and an unwavering belief in limitless possibilities." This sentiment lays the foundation for the narrative that unfolds. Mike Azzarello, a seasoned pilot and founder with a steadfast commitment spanning three decades, has internalized this ethos, shaping WingTips—an innovative, sustainable aviation technology enterprise challenging and reshaping private aviation norms.

Imagine arriving at a private flight terminal just 20 minutes before your flight, handing your keys to valet parking, having your bags swiftly collected, and strolling effortlessly to your pre-booked private plane, with your favourite snacks served alongside a chilled glass of vino awaiting. This is more than a flight; it's an encounter where efficiency blends with secure, chic, and cost-effective travel. The only distinction between a high-cost private charter and a WingTips flight lies in the fact that WingTips passengers pay a fraction of the cost while still enjoying 90% of the experience.

WingTips serve as the conduit, making private travel accessible for those seeking more flair for their fare.

WingTips is your ticket to arriving at your destination four times faster than conventional air travel or driving. Say goodbye to traffic, tolls, and long drive times, as WingTips redefine the essence of airline travel by bringing back true hospitality.



"The sensation of flight is unparalleled; it embodies freedom, exhilaration, and the unwavering belief in limitless possibilities."

WING TIPS

REALM OF *Adventure*

Mike Azzarello, the trailblazing entrepreneur at the helm of WingTips, pioneers a revolutionary technology platform that transforms the mundane logistics of air travel into a digital symphony of algorithms. This innovation is orchestrated through a business model designed to save travelers both time and money. WingTips, a U.S.-based specialist in short-distance travel, provides shared, on-demand chartered flights to regional destinations typically overlooked by commercial airlines.



Mike's 30-year aviation journey faced challenges, shaping his commitment to detail, problem-solving, and innovation.

This incident highlights Mike's dedication to efficiency, excellence, and determination, all marinating in his client-centric approach, traits instilled in a dynamic management team guiding the company's successful European expansion.

Private, accessible, and sustainable encapsulate the trifecta defining the WingTips flight experience.

248,000 people a day (US) would pay for a short-distance flight (under 300 miles) but airlines do not offer this service, losing \$50 million in daily revenue.

A notable incident occurred during a coastal joyride with his then-girlfriend (now wife), when the engine backfired above a crowded beach. Nervously questioning the unusual sound, Mike's wife asked, "Is this normal?" eliciting a firm but loving "No, Dear." He declared an emergency landing, executed a 180-degree turn, and safely landed on the same runway in the opposite direction. Investigation revealed a faulty spark plug.

The lesson: composure is crucial, even in small planes. After renting a different plane and conducting a thorough check, they took to the skies again. The second flight, though sweat-inducing, proceeded without a hitch, leaving everyone with smiles.

What sets WingTips apart is not just their commitment to innovation and sustainability, but their ability to implement groundbreaking technology via their dynamic management team and agile working practices, bettering short-distance aviation globally. Comfort and affordability columnize the entire choreography of the travel experience, removing long waits, extortionate pricing and tedious long-distance drives.

Regional air mobility would create a multi-billion-dollar industry, amounting to a TAM of \$40 billion in the US.